

Word family: **mend / mends / mended / mending / mender**

Base word: mend

Part of speech: mainly **verb**, also **noun**

Related forms:

* **mend** (v.) — 修補；修理；改善；修復

* **mended** (adj./participle) — 已修補的；已改善的

* **mending** (n./gerund) — 修補；縫補

* **mender** (n.) — 修補者；修理者（較少見）

* **on the mend** — 正在康復 / 正在好轉

* **mend fences** — 修補關係

* **mend your ways** — 改過自新；改掉壞習慣

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **mend clothes**

* **mend a tear**

* **mend a hole**

* **mend a fence**

* **mend a relationship**

* **mend a friendship**

* **mend the situation**

* **mend a broken heart**

* **mend fences**

* **on the mend**

* **mend your ways**

Meaning in this passage

> ...when it is honest, timely, and specific, it can really **mend the situation**.

Here, **mend** is figurative.

It means:

improve and repair a damaged situation or relationship — 修補；改善；修復

The apology cannot erase what happened, but it can help repair the emotional damage and improve the relationship.

中文翻譯：

只要道歉是真誠、及時而且具體的，就真的可以**修補局面**。

So here:

mend = 令受損的人際關係、情況或信任逐步恢復和改善

1. **mend (修補衣物 / 物件) — 修補；縫補**

The core literal sense.

Practice 1

> She **mended the torn shirt**.

她把破了的恤衫**縫補好**。

Practice 2

> I need to **mend this hole**.

我需要**補好這個洞**。

Practice 3

> He **mended the broken fence**.

他把破損的圍欄**修好**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend = 修補破損的衣物、物件或結構，使其重新可用****

2. **mend clothes — 縫補衣物**

Practice 1

> My grandmother taught me how to **mend clothes**.

我外婆教我怎樣**縫補衣物**。

Practice 2

> She spent the evening **mending clothes**.

她整晚都在**補衣服**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend clothes = 用針線等修補破損衣物****

3. **mend a tear / hole — 補裂口 / 洞**

Practice 1

> Can you **mend the tear** in my jacket?

你可以幫我**補好外套的裂口**嗎？

Practice 2

> He **mended the hole** in the bag.

他把袋上的洞**補好了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a tear/hole = 把裂開或穿洞的地方修補好****

4. **mend a fence — 修理圍欄**

Practice 1

> He spent the afternoon **mending the fence**.

他整個下午都在**修理圍欄**。

Practice 2

> The farmer **mended the damaged fence**.

農夫把受損的圍欄**修好**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a fence = 修理破損的圍欄，使其重新完整****

5. **mend (figurative : 修復關係) — 修補關係**

A major figurative sense.

Practice 1

> They are trying to **mend their relationship**.

他們正嘗試**修補彼此的關係**。

Practice 2

> The apology helped **mend the friendship**.

那次道歉有助**修復友誼**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a relationship = 在關係受損後努力令它重新改善****

6. **mend the situation — 修補局面；改善情況**

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> A sincere apology can really **mend the situation**.

真誠的道歉真的可以**修補局面**。

Practice 2

> It will take time to **mend the situation**.

要**改善這個局面**需要時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend the situation = 改善一個已經受損、緊張或出現問題的情況****

7. **mend a friendship — 修復友誼**

Practice 1

> They talked honestly and **mended their friendship**.

他們坦誠地談過後，**修復了友誼**。

Practice 2

> It took months to **mend the friendship**.

他們花了幾個月才**修補好這段友誼**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a friendship = 在出現衝突、誤會或傷害後重新建立友好關係****

8. **mend a relationship — 修復關係**

Practice 1

> Trust is essential if you want to **mend a relationship**.

如果你想**修復關係**，信任很重要。

Practice 2

> Both sides need to make an effort to **mend the relationship**.

雙方都需要努力**修補關係**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a relationship = 令受損的人際關係逐步恢復****

9. **mend a broken heart — 撫平心碎；療癒情傷**

A figurative emotional expression.

Practice 1

> Time helped **mend her broken heart**.

時間幫助她**療癒心傷**。

Practice 2

> Friends can help **mend a broken heart**.

朋友可以幫助**撫平情傷**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend a broken heart = 幫助某人從強烈感情傷痛中慢慢恢復****

10. **mend fences — 修補關係；和解**

A very useful idiom.

Practice 1

> The two colleagues met to **mend fences**.

兩名同事見面是為了**修補關係**。

Practice 2

> He called his brother to **mend fences** after the argument.

爭吵後，他打電話給哥哥，希望**和好**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend fences = 改善因衝突、不和或疏遠而受損的關係****

11. **on the mend — 正在康復；正在好轉**

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> She's finally **on the mend** after being ill.

她病後終於**開始康復**。

Practice 2

> The economy appears to be **on the mend**.

經濟似乎正在**好轉**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on the mend = 正在從疾病、問題或困境中逐漸恢復****

12. ****mend (health : 康復) — 好轉 ; 康復****

Less common as a standalone verb in modern everyday English than ****recover****, but still established.

Practice 1

> His leg is ****mending well****.

他的腿****恢復得很好****。

Practice 2

> She slowly ****mended**** after the illness.

她病後慢慢****康復****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend = 身體、傷口或健康狀況逐漸恢復****

13. ****mend your ways — 改過自新 ; 改掉壞習慣****

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> He promised to ****mend his ways****.

他答應會****改過自新****。

Practice 2

> She told him to ****mend his ways**** or leave the team.

她叫他****改掉自己的壞習慣****，否則就離開團隊。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****mend your ways = 改掉壞行為或不良習慣，開始做得更好****

14. **mend (改善局勢 / 情況) — 改善 ; 好轉**

Practice 1

> Relations between the two sides began to **mend**.

雙方關係開始**好轉**。

Practice 2

> The situation is slowly **mending**.

局面正在慢慢**改善**。

MCQ-ready definition:

mend = 受損或困難的情況逐漸改善

15. **mending (修補 ; 縫補) — 修補工作**

Practice 1

> I have some **mending** to do.

我有些**縫補工作**要做。

Practice 2

> She spent the evening doing the **mending**.

她整晚都在做**衣物修補**。

MCQ-ready definition:

mending = 修補衣物或其他破損物件的工作

16. **mended (已修補的) — 已修好的**

Practice 1

> The **mended shirt** looked almost new.

那件**修補好的恤衫**看起來幾乎像新的。

Practice 2

> The fence is finally **mended**.

圍欄終於**修好了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

mended = 已經被修補或修復好的

Important distinction 1: **mend vs repair**

mend

often smaller-scale, traditional, or personal repair:

- * clothes
- * tears
- * fences
- * relationships

repair

broader technical/mechanical repair:

- * car
- * machine
- * computer

> mend a shirt

> 補恤衫

> repair a car

> 修車

There is overlap, but **mend** often feels more human and restorative.

Important distinction 2: **mend vs fix**

fix

very broad, especially AmE:

- * fix a machine

- * fix a problem

mend

often suggests repairing something damaged rather than simply solving a problem.

- > fix the situation

- > 解決局面

- > mend the situation

- > 修補受損局面

The second has a stronger **repair after damage** nuance.

Important distinction 3: **mend vs restore**

Very relevant to your passage.

mend

repair damage.

restore

bring something back to an earlier good state.

- > mend the relationship

- > 修補關係

- > restore trust

- > 恢復信任

They naturally occur together.

Important distinction 4: **mend vs heal**

heal

especially body wounds or emotional wounds recovering.

mend

can describe both physical repair and relationships.

> wounds heal

> 傷口癒合

> mend a friendship

> 修補友誼

For emotional damage, both can work metaphorically, but **heal** focuses more on recovery; **mend** focuses more on repair.

Important distinction 5: **mend vs improve**

improve

become better in any way.

mend

become better specifically after damage/problem.

> improve your English

> 改善英語

> mend a damaged relationship

> 修補受損關係

Important distinction 6: **mend a situation vs solve a problem**

solve

find an answer that removes the problem.

mend

repair the damage and make the situation better.

An apology may not completely solve everything, but it can **mend** the situation.

That nuance is exactly right for your passage.

Important distinction 7: ****mend fences literal vs figurative****

Literal

repair actual fence.

Figurative

repair relationships.

The idiom comes directly from the physical metaphor.

Important distinction 8: ****on the mend****

This does not mean literally “being repaired by someone.”

It means:

****逐漸康復 / 逐步好轉****

It can describe:

- * health
- * economy
- * relationship
- * situation

Important distinction 9: ****mend your ways****

This does not mean repairing a road/path.

It means:

****改掉自己的壞行為****

Learn it as a fixed idiom.

Important distinction 10: ****mend a broken heart****

This does not literally repair the organ.

It is a metaphor for:

****從情感創傷中恢復****

Family-extension note

****Mend**** has a very clear semantic core:

****repair something that has been damaged, broken, or weakened****

That extends naturally into:

1. ****physical objects****

- * mend clothes
- * mend a tear
- * mend a fence

2. ****relationships****

- * mend a friendship
- * mend fences

3. ****situations****

- * mend the situation

4. ****emotions****

- * mend a broken heart

5. ****health/recovery****

- * on the mend
- * leg is mending

6. ****behaviour****

- * mend your ways

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

mend the situation = repair the damage caused by the misunderstanding and make the relationship better again

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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mend (physical)	修補；修理	repair damage
mend clothes	縫補衣物	fabric repair
mend a tear	補裂口	repair damage
mend a hole	補洞	close damage
mend a fence	修理圍欄	physical repair
mend a relationship	修復關係	interpersonal repair
mend a friendship	修補友誼	repair friendship
mend the situation	修補 / 改善局面	repair situation
mend a broken heart	療癒心傷	emotional recovery
mend fences	修補關係；和解	reconcile
on the mend	正在康復 / 好轉	recovery
leg is mending	腿正在康復	health recovery
mend your ways	改過自新	improve behavior
mending	修補工作	repair activity
mended	已修好的	repaired

For your original sentence

> Of course, an apology does not erase everything overnight, but when it is honest, timely, and specific, it can really **mend the situation**.

Here:

mend the situation = 雖然不能令之前的傷害完全消失，但可以把受損的關係、信任和局面逐步修補好

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當然，道歉並不能一夜之間抹走所有事情，但只要它是真誠、及時而且具體的，就真的可以**修補局面**。

The contrast is especially elegant:

> **erase** = 把傷害完全抹去

> **mend** = 傷害仍曾經存在，但把裂痕慢慢修補好

That is why **mend** is such a precise choice here.